

Asian Semis

April WSTS data: Strong YoY growth continues, becoming more broad-based with healthy unit growth and ex-memory ASP uptick

Overall semi revenues rose 106% YoY in April (vs. 88% YoY in March), with logic semis increasing 33% YoY (vs. 25% YoY in March) and memory increasing 359% YoY (vs. 269% YoY in March). Semis marked the eighth consecutive month of acceleration and the highest YoY growth since 1994. This was mostly due to 1) sustained AI compute demand driven by strong growth in AI accelerators (GPUs and ASICs), networking and server CPUs, and 2) ongoing memory ASP strength amid persistently tight supply conditions. Memory growth was driven by CSP-led demand across both HBM and conventional memory, with suppliers continuing to prioritize HBM allocation.

- Logic semi revenue rose 33% YoY (vs. 25% in March), marking 32 consecutive months of YoY growth.** We believe this was mostly due to leading-edge demand, which continues to tighten. Strong demand for N5/N3 wafers—driven by GPUs/ASICs, server CPUs, networking, and Apple iPhone/Mac products—has kept the capacity tight. We believe N3 will be the primary bottleneck for AI accelerators, as most leading AI accelerators (such as NVIDIA Rubin, Google TPU v8t/i, and AWS Trn 3) are expected to adopt N3. We have also seen recent upside in server CPU demand due to booming demand for agentic AI. We now estimate the demand–supply gap for N3 in 2026 at ~600K wafers, equivalent to \$15bn–18bn in foundry revenues. Continued upward revisions to US CSP capex (with total capex for the top four US CSPs now indicating 80%+ YoY growth in 2026) suggest more structural AI demand. We expect the AI-driven semi upcycle to extend at least through 2026, with robust leading-edge demand continuing into 2028. For mature foundries, we see strong demand for AI peripheral products such as PMICs, early signs of industrial recovery, and some PC pull-in. However, downside risk remains from tepid consumer electronics demand given rising memory costs in 2H26.
- Overall, semis units increased 15% YoY (vs. 10% YoY in March). Memory units increased 54% YoY (vs. 21% YoY in March).** We forecast the HBM S-D shortage to worsen over the next three years, with DRAM wafer allocation to HBM continuing to rise (from 24% in 2026E to 31% in 2028E), adding greater pressure on conventional DRAM S-D, as HBM bit installation demand CAGR is likely to be +85% over the next three years. Logic semis units increased 14% YoY (vs. 9% YoY in March). We believe this growth is supported by demand for AI alongside pockets of strength in industrials. In addition, resilient iPhone 17 demand (iPhone shipments up 9% YoY versus overall smartphone shipments down 11% YoY in 2Q26E) especially share gains in the China market and strong customer interest in the MacBook Neo are helping offset weakness in mid- to low-end smartphone demand.
- Overall, semis ASPs were up 79% YoY (vs. 71% YoY in March), driven by tight S-D across leading-edge and memory.** Memory ASPs surged 198% YoY (vs. 206% YoY in March). We expect memory prices to increase 220–250% YoY this year, although we see a rather stable pricing trend next year, supported by a rising LTA contract sales mix. Given the dollar per bit crossover

Technology and Telecoms

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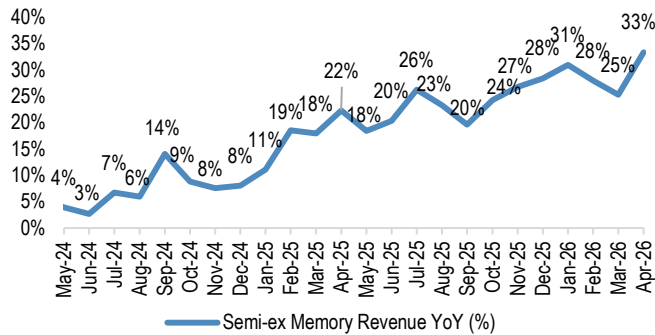
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between HBM and non-HBM, we expect memory makers to turn vocal on raising HBM ASPs next year (+10% YoY like-for-like, +30% blended). Logic semi ASPs rose 18% YoY (vs. 15% in March), supported by price hikes in leading edge node and a continued mix shift toward advanced nodes (higher N3/N5 mix). ASP growth is further supported by rising demand for mature-node (primarily 8") products, driven by AI-related PMICs, power discrete, and industrial applications, with selective price hikes observed in 1H this year. For 2H26, we believe leading edge pricing for hot-runs and super-hot-runs has moved up, but regular N3 pricing is unchanged.

- **Looking ahead, we expect leading-edge capacity tightness to persist well into 2027 or early 2028, driven by strong AI accelerator demand, increasing demand for AI interconnect, rising AI-driven power demand and continued strength from Apple iPhone and Mac.** For memory, our team has revised up the FY26E/28E memory TAM by 37/53% (vs. the Mar-26 model). We now forecast capex at US\$450bn in memory spending over the next three years (vs. US\$300bn in Dec-25 model), with DRAM CY28-end WSPM at 2.8mn (up 880k from CY25-end) and 60% of incremental WSPM allocation directed toward HBM, keeping S-D tight and pricing biased to the upside. Overall, we reiterate our top picks among major AI beneficiaries: TSMC, Mediatek, Lasertec, Tokyo Electron, ASMPT, ASE, Alchip, Unimicron, EMC, SEC, and SK Hynix.

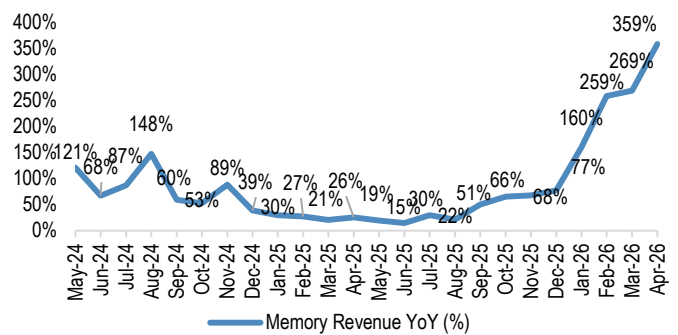
Key charts

Figure 1: Semi ex-memory revenue YoY (May-24 onwards)



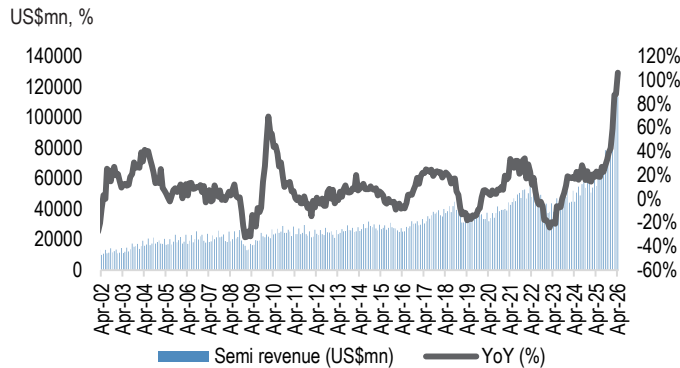
Source: WSTS.

Figure 2: Memory revenue YoY (May-24 onwards)



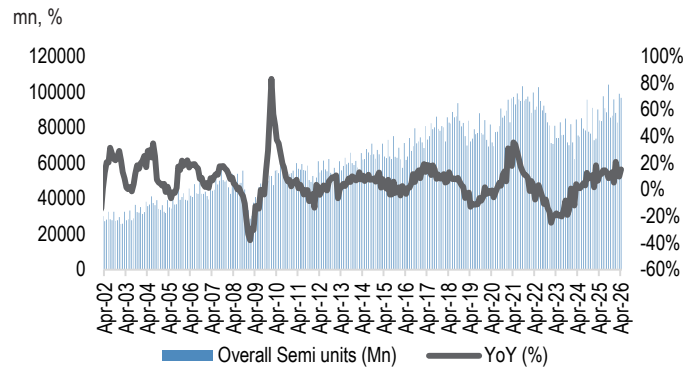
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Figure 3: Semi revenue (monthly) and YoY



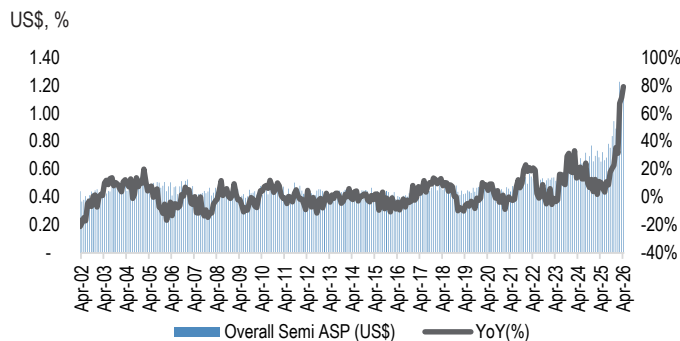
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Figure 4: Semi units (monthly) and YoY



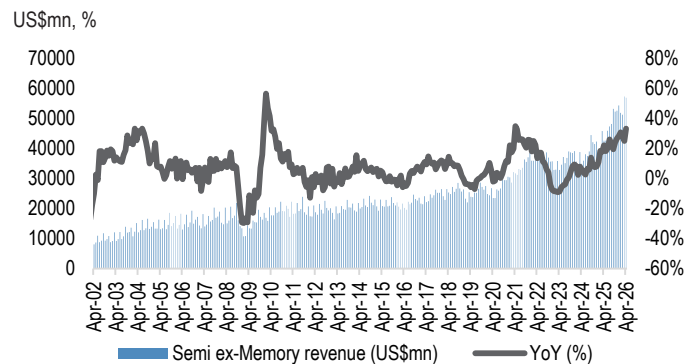
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Figure 5: Semi ASP and YoY



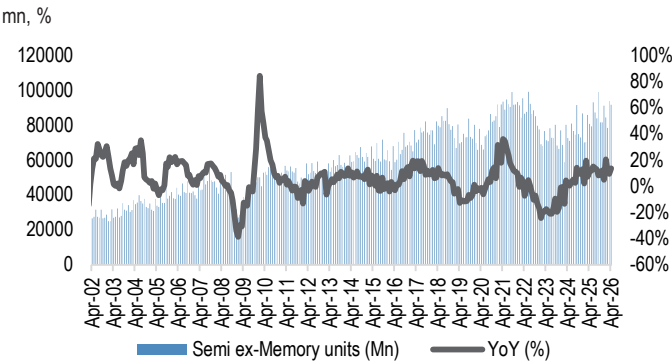
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Figure 6: Semi ex-memory revenue (monthly) and YoY



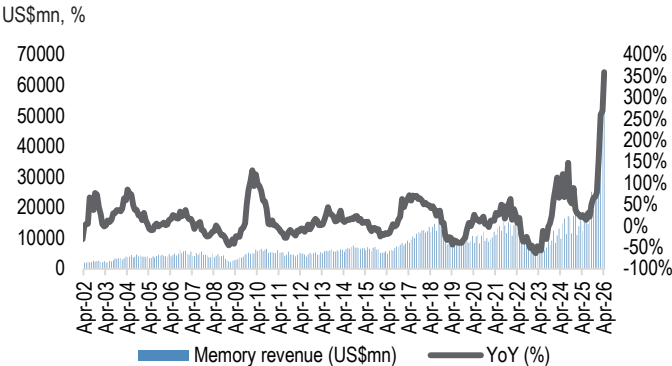
Source: WSTS.

Figure 7: Semi ex-memory units and YoY



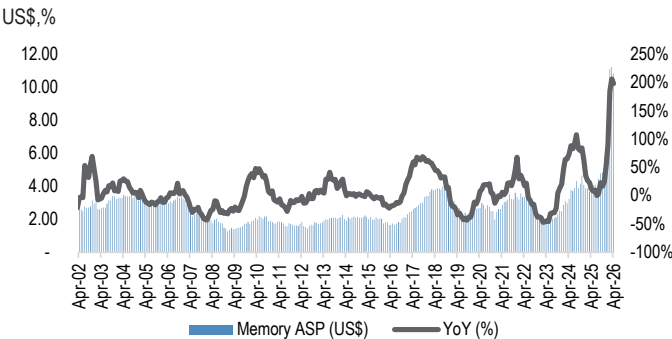
Source: WSTS.

Figure 9: Memory revenue (monthly) and YoY



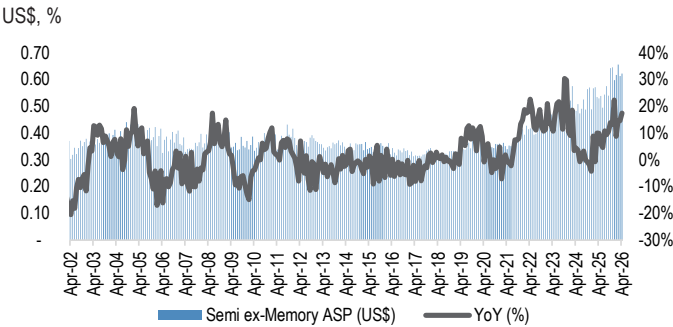
Source: WSTS.

Figure 11: Memory ASP and YoY



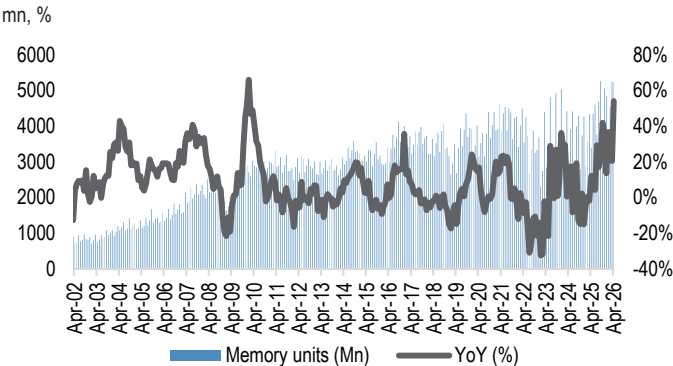
Source: WSTS.

Figure 8: Semi ex-memory ASP and YoY



Source: WSTS.

Figure 10: Memory units and YoY



Source: WSTS.

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